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SECRET
PRIORITY

27 DECEMBER 1943

FROM: WAR
TO: ALUSCA, CHUNGKING #4139

DECLASSIFIED
By Deputy Archivist of the U.S.
By W. J. Stewart Date MAR 9 1972

YOUR NUMBER 955 DECEMBER 23.

ONLY FOR GENERAL STILWELL'S EYES FOR DELIVERY OF THE FOLLOWING MESSAGE FROM THE PRESIDENT TO GENERALISSIMO CHIANG KAI-SHEK.

"I FULLY AGREE TO THE NEED AS EXPRESSED IN YOUR MESSAGE OF DECEMBER 23RD FOR ADEQUATE FIGHTER PROTECTION FOR THE VERY LONG RANGE BOMBER BASES IN CHINA. THE CHIEFS OF STAFF HAVE THEREFORE LOOKED INTO THIS MATTER AND HAVE INCLUDED SUFFICIENT FIGHTER PLANES TO PROTECT THE BASES INVOLVED. IN ORDER NOT TO PLACE TOO HEAVY AN ADDITIONAL CHARGE AGAINST THE AIR FERRY ROUTE FOR THEIR SUPPORT, THESE FIGHTERS WILL BE AN INTEGRAL PART OF THE VERY LONG RANGE BOMBER PROJECT WHICH WILL SUPPORT ITSELF.

"I AM MOST ANXIOUS, IN THE MEANTIME, FOR WORD AS TO THE PROGRESS BEING MADE IN CHINA ON THE VERY LONG RANGE BOMBER FIELDS UPON WHICH THE SUCCESS AND SUPPLY ACTION OF THIS ENTIRE BOMBER OPERATION COMPLETELY DEPEND.

"I KNOW YOU WILL AGREE, DESPITE POSTPONEMENT OF THE YUNNAN FORCE OPERATION AGAINST BURMA, THAT IN THE INTERIM EVERY FAVORABLE OPPORTUNITY MUST BE EXPLOITED TO THE FULLEST WITH THE MEANS AVAILABLE. MOUNTBATTEN IS PLANNING A VERY INTENSIVE CAMPAIGN WITH THE MEANS AT HIS DISPOSAL AND I AM PLEASED THAT YOU HAVE PLACED THE RAILWAY AND LEDO FORCES AT HIS DISPOSAL. AGAIN I WISH TO EMPHASIZE MY VIEWS AS TO THE IMPORTANCE OF ALL POSSIBLE PRESSURE BEING EXERTED BY YOUR YUNNAN FORCES. CONSIDERABLE CRITICAL MATERIALS AND INSTRUCTOR PERSONNEL FOR THE YUNNAN DIVISIONS ARE CURRENTLY SCHEDULED TO BE MOVED BY AIR TO CHINA. THE BASE OF THIS BUILDUP TO MY MIND DEPENDS TO A LARGE DEGREE UPON THE USE TO BE MADE OF THESE

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DIVISIONS IN THE NEAR FUTURE. WE SHOULD THEREFORE AVOID AT THIS TIME, THE USE OF THE RESTRICTED AIR LIFT OR THE EMPLOYMENT OF THESE RESOURCES IN AN EFFORT, THE FULL IMPACT OF WHICH UPON THE ENEMY WILL BE DELAYED.

"I AM INFORMED THAT ON CHRISTMAS DAY A TOTAL OF TEN THOUSAND TONS OF FREIGHT HAD BEEN CARRIED OVER THE HUMP INTO CHINA SO FAR IN DECEMBER. THAT IS GOOD NEWS FOR US BOTH."

ROOSEVELT

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Released from the White House Map Room
at 1555, E.W.T, 27 December 1943.

L. MATTHEWSON,
Colonel, General Staff.

R.P.

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